

skeleton

intervertebral joints

Elements that join the vertebrae together in such a way that the spine can be mobile and flexible.

transverse process

Bony protuberance extending laterally from each side of the vertebra; the muscles are attached to it.

intervertebral foramen

Orifice located between two contiguous vertebrae on each side of the column allowing nerves to pass through.

spinous process

Posterior middle protuberance of the vertebra; the attachment point for the back muscles.

articular processes

Small vertical projections on which the vertebrae are articulated.

vertebral body

Anterior bony cylinder of a vertebra surrounded by two transverse processes.

intervertebral disk

Flat rounded cartilaginous structure separating two vertebrae; its elasticity allows the vertebral column to move.

